

	INTACT (FIRST MARRIAGE)	STEP-FAMILY	LONE PARENT
Household Income			
Less than \$50,000	13%	16%	49%
\$50,000 to \$79,999	19%	21%	20%
\$80,000 to \$99,999	13%	12%	7%
\$100,000 to \$149,999	25%	24%	7%
\$150,000 or more	19%	17%	2%
Not stated	11%	9%	15%

Source: Statistics Canada, General Social Survey, 2011.

Of course, marrying someone with children from a prior union can incur hidden expenses. I've got a friend who has been divorced three times. He has two adopted sons, both in their 20s. He recently fell in love with a beautiful Colombian woman with a 14-year-old son. She's 20 years his junior, but she's crazy about him. When he asked her to marry him, she said yes. It's a real-life *Modern Family*.

My friend's adult children went nuts when they heard the news. "We don't need a little brother, Dad!" they said. "He just got a cut of the family inheritance." Talk about the kids of divorce showing a sense of entitlement!

But my friend went ahead and married his real-life Sofía Vergara. He didn't want to live the rest of his life alone; he wanted a mate. And his mate needed some stability for her son. Meanwhile, my friend is 62 and figures he has only about a decade left of good health. After three hard divorces, he just wants to be happy. But in order to move forward, I advised him to think long and hard about how to stabilize his family dynasty. His two grown sons clearly have expectations, and now he has a new wife and teenager to support. (The solution, by the way, is to provide for the 14-year-old with some kind of endowment or trust. That way, my friend protects his